MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 3

"Lose Control"

Episode 2x03. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x03. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Tuesday, October 4, 2005, 4:41 AM through Wednesday, October 5, 2005, 5:15 AM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x02

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Tuesday, October 4, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Tuesday, October 4, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern; patient	Feb 10, 1979	26
Miss Pearline (new)	7 train passenger	Jun 6, 1933	72
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (back from suspension)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (22 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Nadia Ellerbe	Patient: post-op open fetal surgery	Apr 25, 1977	28
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Malik Ellerbe	Nadia's husband	Jan 30, 1975	30
Brother Kareem Shabazz (new)	Patient: perforated duodenal ulcer	Feb 21, 1953	52
Sister Aminah Shabazz (new)	Kareem's wife	Aug 30, 1956	49
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Thaddeus Boykin (on-screen debut)	Surgical Resident (PGY-3)	Aug 2, 1975	30
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Danielle Pryor-Hollis	Patient: chemotherapy	Feb 17, 1979	26
Kevin Hollis	Danielle's husband	Nov 2, 1975	29
Harriet Baker-Fenwick (debut)	Amond's mother	Oct 5, 1952	52
Odile Lemieux	Curtis's mother	Mar 19, 1936	69
Curtis Lemieux	Patient: heart transplant	Apr 9, 1961	44
Tyrell Pickens	Patient: GSW, second look	Jun 7, 1989	16
Lula Pickens	Tyrell's grandmother	Feb 11, 1941	64
Kordell Pickens	Tyrell's brother	Mar 2, 1994	11
Dr. Solomon Fenwick (debut)	Amond's stepfather	Mar 21, 1948	57

Also appearing: a scrub nurse, two anesthesiologists, a circulating nurse, trauma nurses, a fetal cardiologist and an infusion nurse. Mentioned: the CABG patient (a retired Con Ed engineer),

Gwendolyn Monroe, the imam of the masjid on Sutphin Boulevard, and Russell Jeffries.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. AMOND'S STUDIO - SUNNYSIDE - BATHROOM - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 4:41 AM

43rd Street, off Queens Boulevard. Amond (26) stands at the bathroom sink in a T-shirt, shaving. His skin has a gray, waxy undertone. His hand isn't quite steady. He nicks his jaw. A bead of blood. He stares at it in the mirror.

He hasn't slept. The cell phone sits on the sink, face down, where he left it four hours ago.

MARC (V.O.)
Surgeons are control freaks. It's not a character flaw. It's a job requirement.

He rinses the razor. Wipes his face. Stands up straight and watches his reflection sway, very slightly, like a man on a boat.

MARC (V.O.)
We control the bleeding. We control the field. We control the clock, the temperature, the light.

He grips the sink with both hands. Breathes. In. Out. Then he picks up his ID badge and clips it on.

2 INT. 7 TRAIN - QUEENSBORO PLAZA - DAWN
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 5:22 AM

The elevated train, half empty: construction workers, a nurse in Crocs, a man asleep against the window. Amond stands holding the pole, although there are seats. Sweat on his upper lip. The train lurches into the curve at Queensboro Plaza and his knees go soft. He catches himself on the pole.

An older woman in a church hat, MISS PEARLINE (70s), looks up at him from her seat.

MISS PEARLINE
Baby, sit down before you fall down.

AMOND
(straightening)
I'm fine, ma'am. Thank you.

MISS PEARLINE
(studying him)
You're the color of my kitchen sink.

Amond almost laughs. He doesn't sit.

MARC (V.O.)
And when we can't control something, we pretend. Harder than anybody you've ever met.

The doors open at Court Square. Amond steps off carefully, like a man walking on ice.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 5:38 AM

Marc (26), back from his run, drinks water at the sink. Raven (25) makes toast. Harmony (26) packs three lunches into paper bags and labels them in Sharpie: "M." "R." "H."

RAVEN
(buttering)
You know what's weird?

MARC
Everything in this house.

RAVEN
Amond didn't send his text. (holding up her flip phone) Every morning since August, five-fifteen. "You're late." Even on days we're not late. Especially on days we're not late.

MARC
(checking his own phone)
Me neither.

HARMONY
(labeling a bag)
Maybe he slept in.

RAVEN
Amond Baker has never slept in. Amond Baker sleeps standing up, like a horse.

Marc looks at his phone a second longer. Then texts: "u alive?"

A long pause. Then a reply: "Obviously."

MARC
(relieved, showing them)
"Obviously."

RAVEN
(taking a bite of toast)
That's not a five-fifteen "you're late." That's a six-thirty "leave me alone."

Marc frowns at the phone. Harmony writes a fourth bag: "A." She puts an extra banana in it.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE BOARD - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 6:00 AM

The interns gather. Amond is already there, very upright, very still, holding coffee he isn't drinking. Esther (26) stands at her careful end of the Board. Arianna (25) arrives and stops dead.

Sitting on the edge of the desk, in a crisp white coat, is DR. BRYCE KENNERLY (27), back from his two-week suspension, smiling like nothing happened.

KENNERLY
(cheerful)
Morning, everybody. Did you miss me?

ARIANNA
(flat)
Like a yeast infection.

KENNERLY
(laughing)
Gary. Still charming. (to Esther, pointedly) Smilley. You look great. You always photograph so well.

Esther doesn't even look at him. Marc steps very slightly between them, the way he did in the Pit with Leonard Cole. Not touching. Just there.

MARC
(pleasantly)
Kennerly. Your hearing's next week, right? (beat) I'd stay off the copier.

Kennerly's smile flickers. Elxa (28) sweeps in.

ELXA
Kennerly. You're on Dr. Whitlow's medicine consult service until the board says otherwise. Twelfth floor. Go away.

Kennerly goes, smirking. Elxa opens her charts.

ELXA
Bullock: Dr. Hartwell. Post-op day one on Mrs. Ellerbe, the open fetal. She was contracting overnight. (beat) Smilley: Graves. Divine: Lowery, he's got something in the Pit. Ellison: with me. Tyrell Pickens's second look. Cummings: Gloria. (beat) Baker: Dr. Bullock, Senior. A CABG at seven-thirty. OR Two.

AMOND
(immediately)
Yes.

Elxa looks at him. Then really looks at him.

ELXA
(beat)
Baker, your lips are white.

AMOND
(evenly)
It's the fluorescent lighting.

ELXA
(beat)
The lighting's been the same for thirty years. (beat) Go. But if you so much as yawn wrong, you sit down.

Amond goes. Marc watches him walk away: shoulders too straight, steps too careful. Arianna watches too.

ARIANNA
(low, to Marc)
Watch him today.

MARC
(low)
Why? What do you know?

Arianna hesitates. A promise is a promise.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Just watch him.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF OF MEDICINE'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 6:21 AM

Whitlow (56) behind his mahogany desk, pouring coffee into two china cups. Kennerly sits across from him, delighted to be there.

WHITLOW
Dr. Kennerly. Welcome back. (handing him a cup) Two weeks is a long time to sit at home with your thoughts.

KENNERLY
(taking it)
It was unfair, sir. A prank. They made it into a federal case.

WHITLOW
(sympathetically)
Institutions can be... unforgiving. To some people. (beat) And remarkably forgiving to others.

Kennerly looks up. He's not stupid either.

WHITLOW
(stirring his coffee)
You'll be on my consult service for a while. You'll see every floor. Every service. Every intern. (beat) Interns talk to each other, Dr. Kennerly. In the cafeteria. At that bar on Jackson Avenue. (beat) I like to know what my hospital is saying.

KENNERLY
(slowly)
About anyone in particular?

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
Who do the interns love, Dr. Kennerly? (beat) There's always one. The one the nurses save the good coffee for. The one the attendings let do the interesting parts.

KENNERLY
(immediately, bitterly)
Bullock.

WHITLOW
(beat, smiling)
Bullock. (beat) And why do they love him?

KENNERLY
(beat)
I don't know. He's... nice. He's good. (beat, sour) Annoyingly good.

WHITLOW
(sipping his coffee)
Nobody's that good for free, Dr. Kennerly. (beat) Find out why.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 6:42 AM

Nadia Ellerbe (28), post-op day one after open fetal surgery, lies on her side, gray with fatigue. Her belly is wrapped. A tocodynamometer belt reads her uterus. Clayton (34) studies the strip. Marc reads the overnight notes. Malik (30) holds her hand.

CLAYTON
(pointing at the strip)
Contractions every eight minutes since four a.m. (beat) Her uterus is irritated. Somebody cut it open yesterday and put a baby back in it. It's offended.

NADIA
(weak)
Is he coming?

MARC
Not if we can help it. (to Clayton) Indomethacin?

CLAYTON
(nodding)
Fifty milligrams now, then twenty-five every six hours for forty-eight hours. Keep the magnesium running. (beat) And a fetal echo at noon. Indomethacin can close the ductus. We watch it every day.

MARC
(writing)
Fetal echo at noon.

MALIK
(to Marc)
Doc. Every eight minutes. That's not good, right?

MARC
(honest)
It's not good. (beat) But it's not every three minutes. And she's not dilating. (beat) We're going to make her uterus calm down, Mr. Ellerbe. Twenty-six weeks and two days. Every day he stays in there, we win.

Clayton glances at Marc. A small nod: right answer.

CLAYTON
(low, as they step out)
Baker. Your friend. (beat) I passed him in the elevator. (beat) He looks like a man with a hemoglobin of eight.

Marc stops.

MARC
(beat)
You saw him for ten seconds.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I've watched women hemorrhage for nine years, Bullock. The pale goes into the lips first.

7 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 7:06 AM

BROTHER KAREEM SHABAZZ (52), a big, dignified man with a gray-flecked beard, a kufi, and a Nation-of-Islam-era bow tie he's worn since 1975, lies on the gurney, rigid, with his knees pulled up. His abdomen is board-hard. His wife, SISTER AMINAH SHABAZZ (49), in a hijab, stands beside him. Harmony and DR. ABRAHAM LOWERY (58) examine him. Gloria (53) hangs a bag of fluid.

LOWERY
(pressing gently, Kareem gasping)
Rigid. Rebound. (beat) Upright chest X-ray?

HARMONY
(holding up the film)
Free air under both diaphragms.

LOWERY
(to Kareem)
Mr. Shabazz. You have a hole in your stomach, or the first part of your intestine. Probably an ulcer that went all the way through. Your stomach acid is leaking into your belly. You need surgery today. This morning.

KAREEM
(through his teeth)
Today is the first day of Ramadan.

AMINAH
(gently)
Kareem.

KAREEM
I've fasted thirty Ramadans, Doctor. I haven't broken one since 1976. (beat) I'd ask that nothing go into my body until sunset.

Gloria, holding the IV bag, freezes. Lowery opens his mouth. Harmony steps in first.

HARMONY
(carefully)
Brother Shabazz. My best friend growing up was Muslim. Alicia's mother, Mrs. Monroe, converted in 1985. (beat) She used to tell us the sick don't fast. The traveler and the sick. That God doesn't want hardship.

Kareem turns his head and looks at the young doctor.

KAREEM
(beat)
Surah al-Baqarah. "Allah intends for you ease, and does not intend for you hardship." (beat) You know it?

HARMONY
(beat)
Mrs. Monroe made us memorize it. In English. She said we were going to grow up and need it.

AMINAH
(to her husband, quietly)
Call the imam, Kareem. Call him now. He'll tell you what that girl just told you.

Kareem closes his eyes. A long, pained beat.

KAREEM
(finally)
Get me the phone.

LOWERY
(to Gloria)
Hang the fluids the second he's off the phone. (to Harmony, low) Where did you learn that?

HARMONY
(beat)
Hollis, Queens. (beat) Everything I know, I learned in Hollis.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 7:51 AM

A coronary bypass. The patient's chest is open, the heart arrested on the bypass machine. Robert (49) sews a saphenous vein graft onto a coronary artery with tiny, perfect stitches. Amond, across from him, holds a retractor and the cardiac stabilizer. Sweat beads under his cap and darkens the cloth.

ROBERT
(sewing)
Distal anastomosis to the obtuse marginal. (beat) Seven-oh Prolene. Dr. Baker, what's the target internal diameter?

AMOND
(a half-second slow)
One point... five. One point five millimeters.

Robert glances up. Back down.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Correct.

They work. A minute. Two. Amond blinks several times. The OR lights seem very bright to him. The room tilts, just a degree, and comes back.

SCRUB NURSE
(to Amond)
Doctor? Your cap's soaked.

AMOND
(steady voice)
It's warm in here.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(dry, from behind the drape)
It's sixty-four degrees in here. I'm wearing a sweater.

Robert stops sewing. Looks across the open chest at Amond. Amond's eyes are glassy. His pupils are huge.

ROBERT
(very quietly)
Dr. Baker. Hand the retractor to the nurse.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm fine, sir. I can...

ROBERT
(firm)
Hand it to her. (beat) Now.

Amond lifts his hand off the retractor. His fingers are trembling. The scrub nurse takes it.

AMOND
(stepping back)
I just need...

He doesn't finish. His knees buckle. He goes down sideways, hitting the tile hard, his shoulder catching a Mayo stand, which crashes over in a spray of instruments.

SCRUB NURSE
Dr. Baker!

Robert's hands are inside a man's open chest, a needle in a coronary artery. He can't let go. His whole body jerks toward Amond, and he stops himself, rigid.

ROBERT
(a roar, not taking his hands off the heart)
SOMEBODY GET LOWERY! NOW!

On the floor, Amond lies on his side. Beneath him, slowly spreading through the seat of his scrub pants and onto the tile: dark, maroon blood.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - CONTINUOUS
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 7:53 AM

Chaos at the edges, absolute stillness at the center. The circulating nurse is on the wall phone. The anesthesiologist kneels beside Amond with a blood pressure cuff. Robert keeps his hands exactly where they are, finishing a stitch in an arrested heart, because the patient on the table has no one else.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(on the floor beside Amond)
Pressure's seventy over forty. Heart rate one-thirty-eight. He's thready. (beat) He's bleeding from below. Lots of it. Dark.

ROBERT
(sewing, his voice shaking for the first time anyone in this room has ever heard)
Lower GI. Meckel's diverticulum. Four centimeters, ectopic gastric mucosa. (beat) Dr. Lowery has the chart. Tell him "Baker's Meckel's." He'll know.

CIRCULATING NURSE
(into the phone)
Overhead page Dr. Lowery to OR Two, stat. "Baker's Meckel's." (beat) And send the trauma team.

ROBERT
(to the anesthesiologist)
Two large-bore IVs. Type and cross six units. O-negative from the OR fridge until it's ready. (beat) Lay him flat. Legs up.

The anesthesiologist's tech gets a line into Amond's arm. Amond's eyes flutter open, unfocused.

AMOND
(slurred)
Sir... the graft...

ROBERT
(not looking away from the heart)
The graft is fine, Dr. Baker. I'm finishing your graft. (beat) You hold still.

AMOND
(barely)
I'm sorry.

ROBERT
(beat, his jaw tight)
Don't. (beat) Not now. Later. You can be sorry later. (beat) You have to be alive to be sorry.

Robert ties off the anastomosis. His hands are perfectly steady. His face is not.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - CORRIDOR - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 7:56 AM

Marc is writing in Nadia's chart at the station when his phone buzzes. A text from Arianna.

SMS, from ARIANNA: "baker collapsed OR 2. GI bleed. big. go"

Marc is already running. Clayton, coming around the corner, sees him go.

CLAYTON
(calling after him)
Bullock?

MARC
(over his shoulder, running)
Baker!

Clayton looks at the empty corridor for a second. Then he picks up the station phone.

CLAYTON
(into the phone)
This is Hartwell. Blood bank. (beat) Whatever OR Two is asking for, send double.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 8:01 AM

Lowery bursts in, cap half on, still in his white coat. Two trauma nurses with a gurney behind him. Marc right behind them.

LOWERY
(seeing the blood on the floor)
Lord God. (kneeling) Son. Amond. Look at me.

AMOND
(focusing, barely)
Fever, black stool or syncope. (beat, a ghost of a smile) Pick two.

LOWERY
(grim)
You picked all three. (to the nurses) On the gurney. OR Seven. It's open. (beat) Hemoglobin?

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(reading a slip)
Point-of-care, six point four.

Marc is on his knees beside the gurney before anyone tells him to, helping slide Amond across. Amond's hand finds his wrist and grips it.

AMOND
(whispering)
Don't tell my mother.

MARC
(steady)
Your mother's going to find out, Amond. You're going to be alive when she does.

LOWERY
(to Marc, as they lift the gurney)
Bullock. You're scrubbing with me.

Marc looks up, startled.

LOWERY
(moving)
Boykin's in the Pit with my perforated ulcer. Elxa's in OR Three with a liver. You're the only pair of surgical hands I can find in the next ninety seconds. (beat) You'll assist. And you won't cry on my field. Can you do that?

MARC
(beat, standing)
Yes, sir.

They roll. At the table, Robert keeps sewing. He can't turn around. He listens to them go.

ROBERT
(to no one, very quiet)
Go. (beat) Go.

12 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 8:05 AM

Kareem on the phone. Harmony stands beside the bed. DR. THADDEUS BOYKIN (30), PGY-3, lanky, with wire glasses and

a Rutgers T-shirt under his white coat, arrives breathless.

BOYKIN
Divine. Lowery's gone. He said, "Boykin, you have my ulcer." (beat) Hi. I'm the ulcer guy now.

KAREEM
(into the phone)
Yes, Imam. (beat) Yes. (beat) I understand. (beat) May Allah reward you. (he hangs up)

He lies back. Aminah takes his hand. A long beat.

KAREEM
(to Harmony)
The Imam said the same thing you said. (beat) And then he said: "Kareem, the strongest faith in the world isn't worth a hole in your stomach." (beat) He also said I'm stubborn.

AMINAH
(dry)
He's known you since 1975.

KAREEM
(to Boykin)
Do what you need to do, Doctor. (beat) I'll make the day up after Eid.

BOYKIN
(to Gloria)
Hang it. Pip-tazo, pantoprazole and an NG tube. OR in thirty minutes. (to Harmony) You're with me. You're going to do more of this than you expect.

HARMONY
(beat)
Lowery's patient. Lowery left.

BOYKIN
(pushing the gurney)
Lowery's operating on an intern who almost bled out in a cardiac OR. (beat) Today you're operating on Lowery's patient.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 7 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 8:24 AM

Amond under general anesthesia, intubated, three units of blood hanging, a rapid infuser warming them. His belly is open through a short lower midline incision. Lowery operates. Marc assists, his hands steady inside his best friend's abdomen. An ANESTHESIOLOGIST pumps a bag of blood.

LOWERY
(running the small bowel hand over hand)
Ileocecal valve. Measuring back. (beat) Thirty centimeters. Forty. (beat) Fifty-five. (beat) There.

Sticking out of the side of the bowel like a thumb: a purple, inflamed pouch, about four centimeters long. And at its base, on the bowel wall opposite it, a deep, angry ulcer with a vessel spurting bright red into the lumen.

MARC
(quietly)
The ectopic gastric mucosa ulcerated the ileum across from it. (beat) It's eaten into a branch of the mesenteric.

LOWERY
Right. Which means I'm not just taking the diverticulum. I'm taking the segment. (beat) Clamps. Bullock, hold this loop and do not let go.

Marc holds the loop of bowel. Lowery clamps the mesentery above and below.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Pressure's eighty over fifty. Hemoglobin on the gas is five point nine.

LOWERY
(working fast)
Keep pumping. (beat) Bullock, talk to me. What happens if we lose him on this table?

MARC
(absolutely steady)
We don't.

LOWERY
(glancing up)
That's not a medical answer, son.

MARC
(eyes on the bowel)
It's not a medical question.

Lowery almost smiles under his mask. Through the glass of the viewing gallery, unnoticed: Robert, gown off and sweat-soaked, his CABG closed by his fellow, standing with both hands flat on the glass.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 7 - VIEWING GALLERY - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 8:41 AM

Robert stands at the glass looking down. The door opens behind him. Natasha (47), out of breath, comes in and stands beside him. Below them, Lowery and Marc work on Amond.

NATASHA
(quietly)
Bernie heard the overhead page. "Baker's Meckel's." (beat) Robert. You knew.

ROBERT
(not turning)
For three weeks. (beat) Since the scrub room at Staten Island. September eighth. He was holding his side.

NATASHA
And you let him wait until the fourteenth.

ROBERT
(beat)
I let him choose. (beat) He's a grown man and a physician, and he had capacity. I wrote everything down. I had his word. (beat) And last night he saw blood and didn't call me.

NATASHA
(beat)
How do you know he saw it last night?

ROBERT
(very quiet)
Because he didn't send Marc his five-fifteen text this morning. (beat) He's sent it every day since August. Marc told the anesthesiologist.

Below them, the anesthesiologist calls something. Lowery's voice rises. They can't hear through the glass. Natasha grips Robert's arm.

NATASHA
(barely)
What's happening?

Robert leans toward the glass, reading the monitors upside down from fifteen feet away, a cardiac surgeon's eyes.

ROBERT
(flat, terrible)
Pressure's sixty.

Below, Lowery shouts, and this time they hear it through the glass:

LOWERY
(muffled)
HANG EVERYTHING WE HAVE. NOW.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 7 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 8:43 AM

Blood pours into Amond from four bags at once through the rapid infuser. The anesthesiologist pushes phenylephrine. Lowery's hands are inside the mesentery.

LOWERY
The clamp slipped on the mesenteric branch. (beat) Bullock. Two fingers. Right here. Press until I tell you to stop.

Marc presses two fingers down on the bleeding vessel. The spurting stops under his fingertips. He doesn't move. He doesn't breathe.

LOWERY
(placing a new clamp beneath Marc's fingers)
Good. (beat) Don't move. (beat) Don't move. (beat) Okay. Lift.

Marc lifts his fingers. The clamp holds. No bleeding.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(beat)
Pressure seventy-five. Eighty. Eighty-eight over fifty-two. (beat) He's coming up.

Marc lets out a breath he's been holding for a minute and a half.

LOWERY
(tying off the vessel)
Ligated. (beat) Now we take the segment. Stapler.

Lowery fires the linear stapler across the bowel above and below the diverticulum and the ulcer, then lifts the diseased segment out. Fifteen centimeters of purple,

bleeding bowel, with the Meckel's diverticulum hanging off it like an accusation.

LOWERY
(dropping it in the basin)
There's your demon, Dr. Baker. (beat) Side-to-side stapled anastomosis. Bullock, you're going to close the common enterotomy. Running three-oh Vicryl.

MARC
(beat)
Me?

LOWERY
(handing him the needle driver)
You held a bleeding mesenteric artery with two fingers for ninety seconds and didn't blink. (beat) You can sew bowel, son.

Marc takes the needle driver. He begins to sew. Steady, even, perfect stitches in his best friend's intestine.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you that the worst thing in surgery is losing control. (beat) They don't tell you about the other thing. Being handed it.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 9:10 AM

Tyrell Pickens's second look. The temporary closure is open. Elxa, on her tall stool, and Raven remove the laparotomy pads one by one from around the liver. Each one comes out heavy and red, but nothing gushes behind it.

ELXA
(lifting the last pad)
Last one. (beat) Watch the raw surface.

Everyone watches. The torn liver oozes a little, then stops. The clot holds.

RAVEN
(exhaling)
It's holding.

ELXA
It's holding. (beat) Warm, resuscitated, coagulopathy corrected. This is why we wait forty-eight hours. (beat) Bullet stays where it is, next to the cava. He'll carry it to North Carolina. Set off a metal detector at the Raleigh airport someday.

Raven laughs. Then she glances at the door.

RAVEN
(low)
Is it true? Amond?

ELXA
(beat, eyes on the liver)
Gloria called the board. He collapsed in OR Two. (beat) Lowery and my brother have him in Seven.

Raven stops. Turns her head. Elxa doesn't notice what she just said. Raven does.

RAVEN
(very carefully)
Your... brother?

A beat. Elxa's hands freeze for half a second over Tyrell's liver. Then she keeps working, as if nothing happened.

ELXA
(evenly)
Lowery and Bullock. Close the fascia, Ellison. Number one PDS. (beat) Looped.

Raven picks up the suture. Her eyes stay on Elxa for a long moment above her mask. Then she starts to close.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 9:15 AM

Kareem Shabazz's belly is open. Boykin operates. Harmony assists. In the first part of the duodenum, just past the stomach: a neat, round hole, the size of a pencil eraser, edges inflamed, leaking.

BOYKIN
Anterior duodenal perforation. Classic. (beat) Graham patch. You know what that is, Divine?

HARMONY
(beat)
You don't sew the hole closed. The tissue's too inflamed; it'll tear. You put sutures across it and tie a piece of omentum over it. Like a cork.

BOYKIN
(impressed)
Like a cork. (beat) Hand me the omentum.

Harmony mobilizes a tongue of fatty omentum and brings it up to the hole. Boykin places three sutures across the perforation.

BOYKIN
(holding out the needle driver)
Tie them down over the omentum. Snug. Not strangling. You're tucking it in, not hanging it.

Harmony takes it, ties the first suture. Then the second. Then the third. The omentum sits over the hole like a plug.

BOYKIN
(checking)
Watertight. (beat) Good. (beat) Yesterday two Australians won the Nobel Prize for discovering this hole is caused by a bacterium. (beat) Today we test him for H. pylori, give him two weeks of antibiotics, and he never gets another one.

HARMONY
(beat)
He refused the IV this morning because of the fast.

BOYKIN
(irrigating)
And then you quoted the Quran at him. (beat) Lowery told me. Ninety seconds before he ran out. (beat) He said, "Divine talked a man out of dying for his principles." (beat) That's not in the curriculum.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 10:02 AM

Arianna, at her locker, pulls a clean scrub top over her head. Kennerly comes in, on his way somewhere, and stops.

KENNERLY
(casual)
So Baker crashed in a cardiac OR. Hemorrhaged on the floor. (beat) Should've known. The guy runs on espresso and contempt.

ARIANNA
(not turning)
Say one more word about Baker, Kennerly, and you'll be the one bleeding on the floor.

KENNERLY
(holding up his hands)
Relax, Gary. (beat) I'm just making conversation. (beat) Hey. Bullock assisted on him? With Lowery? (beat) An intern, assisting on a hemorrhaging laparotomy in his fourth month. (beat) Lowery's never let me hold a retractor without yelling.

ARIANNA
(shutting her locker)
Lowery's met you.

KENNERLY
(beat, curious, too casual)
I'm just saying. Bullock gets the good cases. The good attendings. The Chief smiles at him. (beat) Where's he from, anyway? Bullock?

Arianna turns and looks at him for a long, flat moment.

ARIANNA
(deadpan)
Washington, D.C. His grandfather drove a bus. (beat) And Lowery picked him because he was the only intern in the hallway who wasn't you.

She walks out. Kennerly watches her go. He takes out a small notebook and writes something down.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INFUSION CENTER - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 11:22 AM

A bright room of recliners, IV poles and patients in blankets. DANIELLE PRYOR-HOLLIS (26), second cycle of AC chemotherapy running into her port (pushed back a day for her blood counts), sits with a wool cap in her lap. Kevin (29) sits beside her. Esther passes by the open door on her way to the neuro floor, and Danielle calls out.

DANIELLE
Dr. Smilley!

Esther stops. Comes in, surprised.

ESTHER
Mrs. Hollis. How are you doing?

DANIELLE
(holding up a hand: a clump of hair between her fingers)
It started on Saturday. In the shower. (beat) I wanted to do it before it does it. (beat) I asked the nurse for clippers. She's getting some. (beat) Will you do it? I don't want Kevin to.

KEVIN
(gently)
I'd do it.

DANIELLE
I know you would, baby. (beat) That's why I don't want you to. I don't want the last thing you see of my hair to be you taking it.

The NURSE comes back with electric clippers and hands them to Esther. Esther looks at them. Then at Danielle.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Okay.

She turns them on. A buzz. She runs them gently from Danielle's forehead back. A thick strip of hair falls onto the blanket. Danielle closes her eyes. Esther keeps going, careful, slow.

DANIELLE
(eyes closed)
I heard about you. The husband. From Boston. (beat) The nurses talk.

ESTHER
(beat, working)
Everybody talks.

DANIELLE
(beat)
At my wedding I said, "I decide you." (beat) You know what I meant? (beat) I didn't mean I decided Kevin was enough. I meant I decided I wasn't going to wait for something to decide for me. Not cancer. Not my mother's history. Not his mother. (beat) Me.

Esther's hands slow.

DANIELLE
(opening her eyes)
Twenty-something days, they said. Thirty days. (beat) Don't let the calendar decide, Dr. Smilley.

The last of the hair falls. Danielle's scalp is smooth. She runs a hand over it. Kevin takes the clippers out of Esther's hand, turns them on, and runs them right down the middle of his own head.

DANIELLE
(laughing, crying)
KEVIN.

KEVIN
(grinning, a bald stripe down his scalp)
For better or worse, I said. (beat) This is the worse. It's very cold.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 12:10 PM

A fetal echo. A FETAL CARDIOLOGIST scans Nadia's belly. Clayton watches the screen. Malik watches Clayton.

FETAL CARDIOLOGIST
Ductus is open. No constriction. Contractions every twenty minutes now.

CLAYTON
(exhaling)
The indomethacin's working. (to Nadia) He's quieter, Mrs. Ellerbe. So is your uterus. (beat) Twenty-six weeks and two days. We're winning.

MALIK
(beat)
Where's Dr. Bullock?

CLAYTON
(beat)
In surgery. On a friend. (beat)
He'll be back.

NADIA
(weakly)
A friend? (beat) Is the friend
okay?

Clayton looks at the closed door a moment.

CLAYTON
(honest)
I don't know yet.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 7 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 12:40 PM

The end of the operation. Lowery closes the fascia. Marc closes the skin with staples. Amond is pink again under the drapes, six units of blood later. The anesthesiologist checks a final gas.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Hemoglobin nine point one.
Pressure one-ten over
sixty-eight. He's stable.

LOWERY
(stepping back from
the table, pulling
down his mask)
Fifteen centimeters of ileum and
a Meckel's diverticulum with an
ulcer in it you could put your
thumb in. (beat) Eleven days
early. (beat) If he'd made it to
the fourteenth, I'd have been
doing this on a corpse.

Marc keeps stapling. His hands are steady. But when he finishes, he stands at the table with his gloved hands resting on the drapes over his friend's chest and doesn't move.

LOWERY
(gently)
Bullock. (beat) You can step back now.

MARC
(not moving)
He sends me a text every morning at five-fifteen. "You're late." (beat) Even when I'm not late.

LOWERY
(beat)
Then tomorrow morning, you'll be late. (beat) And he'll be alive to tell you.

Marc steps back from the table. He pulls off his gloves and walks out of the OR, through the scrub room and into the hall, where he stops, puts both hands over his face and finally lets himself shake.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - SCRUB ROOM - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 1:32 PM

Harmony scrubs out after the Graham patch. The door opens. Lowery, still in his bloody OR gown, gray with exhaustion, comes in and stands at the next sink.

LOWERY
(scrubbing)
Boykin tells me the patch is watertight.

HARMONY
Yes, sir. Three sutures and an omental plug. He let me tie them.

LOWERY
(beat)
Good. (beat) I left you with my patient this morning, Dr. Divine. I didn't even look back.

HARMONY
(quietly)
You had to go. (beat) Is Amond...?

LOWERY
Alive. Six units. Fifteen centimeters of bowel. He'll be fine. (beat) Bullock held a mesenteric artery closed with two fingers for a minute and a half.

Harmony's hands stop under the water.

LOWERY
(turning off his tap)
And you talked a man of faith into surgery without insulting his faith. Before eight in the morning. (beat) I've been doing this since 1979, young lady. (beat) That's two things I'll remember about today.

He goes. Harmony stands at the sink with the water running, eyes closed.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 7 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 2:10 PM

Amond, extubated, groggy, an NG tube in his nose, a PCA button in his hand, two units of blood still running. Robert sits in the chair beside the bed. He has been sitting there for forty minutes without moving. Amond opens his eyes.

AMOND
(hoarse)
The graft.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Patent. He's in the CVICU. (beat) You'd like him. He's a retired Con Ed engineer. He'll go home Friday.

A long beat.

AMOND
(barely)
I'm sorry.

ROBERT
(beat)
Now you can be sorry.

AMOND
(eyes closing)
I saw it last night. At eleven fifty-two. (beat) Black. (beat) I had the phone in my hand. Your number on the screen.

ROBERT
(very still)
And you didn't press it.

AMOND
(beat)
I thought... if I came in and did the CABG and then called Lowery at noon... (beat) I thought I could control it.

ROBERT
(leaning forward, his voice low and shaking)
You fell on my floor, Dr. Baker. You hit a Mayo stand. You bled through your scrubs onto the tile. (beat) And I had my hands inside a man's chest, and I could not leave the table.

Amond's eyes open.

ROBERT
(barely holding it together)
Do you know what that's like? (beat) Twenty-three years of cardiac surgery. I have never not been able to leave a table before. (beat) I stood there and sewed a coronary artery and listened to you breathe on the floor, and I could not turn around.

Silence. Amond's eyes fill. He tries to look away and can't.

AMOND
(whispering)
My father. Stocker Street. (beat) I couldn't do anything. (beat) I didn't want to be the one who needed somebody.

ROBERT
(beat, softer)
I know, son. (beat) But you are. Today you are. (beat) And you're going to let somebody be there.

Robert sits back. He wipes his face with his hand, fast.

ROBERT
(steady again)
Three weeks of medical leave. Starting now. Lowery's orders, and mine. (beat) You're not off my service. (beat) You're on leave from it.

AMOND
(beat)
Three weeks.

ROBERT
(standing)
And Dr. Baker? (beat) Next time, press the button.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 2:31 PM

Robert comes into the stairwell and stops on the landing. Marc is sitting on the steps, still in OR scrubs, his elbows on his knees. Robert sits beside him. Father and son, finally alone.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Lowery says you held the mesenteric for ninety seconds.

MARC
(staring at the stairs)
He did the operation, Dad.

ROBERT
(beat)
He told me what you said. When he asked you what happens if you lose him on the table. (beat) "We don't."

MARC
(beat)
That wasn't a plan. That was me being scared.

ROBERT
(beat)
That's the only plan anybody ever has, Marc-Anthony. (beat) The rest is technique.

A long silence. Then Robert puts a hand on the back of Marc's neck, the way he did when Marc was small.

ROBERT
(his voice breaking)
Thank you. (beat) For being in the hallway today. (beat) I couldn't turn around. (beat) You could.

Marc leans against his father's shoulder. Neither of them says anything else.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 2:47 PM

Natasha at her desk, on the phone.

NATASHA
(into the phone)
Mrs. Baker-Fenwick, this is Dr. Natasha Donohue. I'm the Chief of Surgery at Queens Grace. (beat) Your son is alive. I want you to hear that first. (beat) He had a bleeding Meckel's diverticulum this morning. He collapsed in an operating room. Dr. Lowery operated. He received six units of blood. He's awake and talking.

HARRIET (V.O.)
(on the phone, crisp Baldwin Hills, a long, stunned pause)
A Meckel's. (beat) He's had stomachaches since he was seven. I told his father it was nerves.

NATASHA
(gently)
Mrs. Baker-Fenwick...

HARRIET (V.O.)
(sharp, the voice of a woman holding herself together by force)
What time is it in New York? Three? (beat) Solomon! (beat) There's a two-fifteen out of LAX. I'll be at JFK by ten-thirty. (beat) Don't let him tell you not to call me, Dr. Donohue. He'll try.

NATASHA
(beat, almost smiling)
He already did, ma'am. (beat) We called you anyway.

HARRIET (V.O.)
(beat, quieter)
Thank you. (beat) Is he eating?

NATASHA
He has a tube in his nose and no small intestine to spare for a few days.

HARRIET (V.O.)
(beat)
Then I'll bring the macaroni and cheese for when he does.

26 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - NURSES' STATION - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 3:12 PM

Arianna sits at the station staring at a chart she isn't reading. Gloria sets a cup of coffee in front of her and sits down.

GLORIA
You've been on that page for twenty minutes, baby.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I knew. (beat) Since September eighth. I found him in the on-call room holding his side. He made me promise. (beat) I kept it. I'm good at keeping things.

GLORIA
(beat)
And now you're sitting here thinking you almost kept him to death.

ARIANNA
(barely)
Yes.

Gloria takes a long sip of her own coffee.

GLORIA
(quietly)
Thirty years in this ER, I've learned something about secrets. (beat) Keeping somebody's secret isn't the same thing as keeping them safe. Sometimes it's the opposite. (beat) You didn't know that this morning. (beat) Now you do.

ARIANNA
(beat)
He'd have hated me if I told.

GLORIA
(standing)
He'd have hated you alive, with all his blood. (beat) Most people can live with being hated, Dr. Cummings. Nobody lives through six units on a floor.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - CORRIDOR - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 3:24 PM

Elxa, waddling, a hand on her lower back, reads a lab sheet at the SICU desk. Raven comes up beside her.

RAVEN
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Can I ask you something?

ELXA
(not looking up)
If it's about Pickens, his lactate's normal.

RAVEN
It's not about Pickens. (beat) In OR Three this morning. You said Lowery and your brother have Amond in Seven.

Elxa's pen stops.

ELXA
(evenly, still not looking up)
I said Lowery and Bullock.

RAVEN
(beat)
You said "my brother," Dr. Bullock. (beat) I was standing two feet away from you.

Elxa finally looks at her. Her face is perfectly pleasant and completely closed.

ELXA
(beat)
Dr. Ellison. I was standing over a grade four liver laceration at twenty-two weeks pregnant on four hours of sleep. (beat) I've called Russell "Mama" twice this week. (beat) Leave it.

RAVEN
(beat)
Okay.

ELXA
(going back to the lab sheet)
Thank you.

Raven walks away. She doesn't look back. But she says, very quietly, to herself:

RAVEN
(under her breath)
"Bullock's a common name."

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE THE SICU - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 3:51 PM

Natasha comes out of the SICU. Whitlow is waiting in the hallway with a sympathetic face and a manila folder under his arm.

WHITLOW
Natasha. (beat) Terrible business. That poor young man. (beat) How is he?

NATASHA
(walking)
Alive, Horace.

WHITLOW
(falling into step)
Thank God. (beat) I'm told he'd known about the diagnosis for some weeks. And that his supervising attending knew. (beat) Your husband.

Natasha stops walking.

WHITLOW
(gently)
I'm not suggesting anything improper, of course. (beat) But a first-year intern, with a known GI bleed, scrubbed into a cardiac case under the Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery, who is married to the Chief of Surgery. (beat) The board will ask questions about supervision. Wouldn't you?

NATASHA
(very quietly)
Horace. A twenty-six-year-old man almost bled to death on an operating room floor this morning. (beat) He has a tube in his nose and his mother is on a plane from Los Angeles. (beat) Have the decency to wait until he's eating solid food.

WHITLOW
(beat, a small bow)
Of course. (beat) I'll wait until Thursday the twentieth.

He walks away. Natasha stands alone in the corridor, her hands trembling at her sides, very slightly.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 7 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 4:16 PM

Amond dozes. Odile Lemieux (69) comes in quietly, her church hat on, a Bible under her arm, and sits down in Robert's chair. Amond opens his eyes and sees her.

AMOND
(hoarse)
Mrs. Lemieux.

ODILE
(patting his hand)
Hush. (beat) I told you, baby doctor. Didn't I tell you?

AMOND
(a weak almost-smile)
"The water don't read the calendar."

ODILE
The water don't read the calendar. (beat) Curtis is upstairs, sitting up, eating Jell-O, mad you didn't come see him today. (beat) His doctor says the rejection's going down already.

AMOND
(beat)
Good.

ODILE
(opening the Bible on her lap)
Your mama coming?

AMOND
(closing his eyes)
From Los Angeles. Tonight.

ODILE
Then I'll sit with you till she comes. (beat) That's what we do in the Lower Nine, baby. Somebody's in the attic, somebody else sits with them till the boat comes.

She begins to read softly from the Psalms. Amond doesn't argue.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF OF MEDICINE'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 4:52 PM

Whitlow at his desk. Kennerly stands in front of it, flipping a little notebook.

KENNERLY
I asked around, like you said. (beat) Bullock's from D.C. Cummings says his grandfather drove a bus. (beat) That's it. Bus driver's grandson. Nothing special. (beat) He lives in Hunters Point with three roommates. He's popular because he's nice. That's literally it.

Whitlow is very still.

WHITLOW
(slowly)
A bus. (beat) In Washington.

KENNERLY
That's what she said. (beat) Why? Is that something?

Whitlow opens a desk drawer and takes out a thick binder: "QGH MEDICAL STAFF - ATTENDING CVs - 2005." He flips to "BULLOCK, ROBERT, M.D." and runs a finger down the page. "Born Washington, D.C., 1956. Son of Walter Bullock, WMATA Metrobus operator (ret.)."

He looks up at Kennerly with the warmest smile in Queens.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
Thank you, Dr. Kennerly. (beat) That's all for today.

Kennerly, confused, leaves. Whitlow sits back. He takes out the staff directory. "BULLOCK, M. - PGY-1." He looks at it the way he looked at it last night. This time he doesn't smile and shake his head.

WHITLOW
(to himself, softly)
Not so common after all.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 5:09 PM

Curtis Lemieux (44), day two of pulse steroids, sits up with a cup of Jell-O and a moon face starting from the prednisone. Robert comes in with the chart, gray with exhaustion, and checks the monitor.

CURTIS
(immediately)
Where's my baby doctor?

ROBERT
(beat)
Downstairs. In the SICU. (beat) He had surgery this morning, Mr. Lemieux. He's going to be all right.

Curtis puts the Jell-O down.

CURTIS
(quiet)
Mama told me. She said he was gray. (beat) She said it at nine o'clock this morning, Doc. She said, "That boy's lying."

ROBERT
(beat)
Your mother was right.

CURTIS
(beat)
My mother's always right. It's exhausting. (beat) Tell him something for me?

ROBERT
Of course.

CURTIS
(beat)
Tell him he made two hundred calls for my mama. (beat) Now it's somebody's turn to make some for him.

Robert stands at the foot of the bed a moment longer than he needs to.

ROBERT
(quietly)
His mother's on a plane from Los Angeles.

CURTIS
(picking up the Jell-O again)
Good. (beat) Everybody needs somebody to come in a boat.

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 5:26 PM

Tyrell Pickens, his belly closed now, extubated and awake. Lula sits by the bed knitting something very large and very orange. Kordell does homework on the windowsill. Raven checks the incision.

RAVEN
No more packing. Your liver held. (beat) Dr. Bullock says you can start clear liquids tomorrow.

TYRELL
(hoarse)
And the bullet?

RAVEN
It stays. Next to your vena cava. It's not hurting anybody there. (beat) You'll set off metal detectors for the rest of your life.

KORDELL
(from the windowsill, delighted)
That's so cool.

LULA
(not looking up from her knitting)
It is not cool, Kordell.

TYRELL
(beat, to Raven)
Grandma's knitting me a sweater for North Carolina. (beat) It's orange. (beat) I'm gonna look like a traffic cone.

LULA
(still knitting)
You're gonna look like a boy who's alive and warm. (beat) Traffic cones keep people safe, Tyrell.

Raven laughs. Tyrell almost does.

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE ENTRANCE - LOBBY - DAY
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 5:44 PM

Esther, in her coat, heading out. Clayton, coming in from the parking garage, meets her by the revolving door.

CLAYTON
Es. (beat) I heard about Baker.

ESTHER
(beat)
He'll live. Lowery took fifteen centimeters of ileum.

CLAYTON
(beat)
And Bullock assisted.

ESTHER
(beat)
I heard.

CLAYTON
(watching her face)
You light up when you say his name, Es. Even when you're trying not to. Even when it's somebody else's name in the sentence.

Esther doesn't answer.

CLAYTON
(beat, gently)
Thursday. Dinner. After Dr. Greenidge. (beat) Not a date. Just dinner. Like two people who used to eat together.

ESTHER
(beat, looking past him at the street)
A Danielle Pryor-Hollis told me today not to let the calendar decide.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Who's that?

ESTHER
(beat)
A woman who shaved her head today rather than wait for her hair to fall out. (beat) Thursday. Dinner. (beat) Just dinner.

She goes out through the revolving door. Clayton watches her, then walks into the hospital.

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 4 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 6:32 PM

Sunset. The SICU window is turning orange over Long Island City. Kareem Shabazz, post-op, an NG tube in, lies propped up. Aminah sits beside him with a small paper cup. Harmony stands at the foot of the bed with her watch.

HARMONY
(looking at her watch)
Six thirty-two. (beat) The masjid on Sutphin says sunset is six thirty-one tonight.

KAREEM
(weak, smiling)
Then I'm a minute late. (beat) First time in thirty years.

Aminah takes a single ice chip from the cup. Kareem is NPO, but Harmony nods: one ice chip is allowed. Aminah places it on his lips.

KAREEM
(quietly)
Bismillah.

He lets the ice chip melt on his tongue, eyes closed. Aminah murmurs a prayer. Harmony bows her head.

KAREEM
(opening his eyes, to Harmony)
Doctor. (beat) Tell Mrs. Monroe in Hollis I said "Ramadan Mubarak." (beat) And thank her for teaching you.

HARMONY
(eyes bright)
I will, Brother Shabazz.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 7 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 7:34 PM

Odile has gone back upstairs to Curtis. Marc sits in the chair, still in scrubs, eating the banana from the lunch bag Harmony labeled "A." Amond watches him.

AMOND
(hoarse)
That's my banana.

MARC
You're NPO. (beat) It's a very good banana.

AMOND
(beat)
Lowery said you closed the enterotomy.

MARC
Running three-oh Vicryl.

AMOND
(beat)
Was it pretty?

MARC
(beat, very seriously)
It was beautiful, Amond. You'd have hated how good it was.

Amond almost laughs. It hurts. He presses the PCA button.

MARC
(beat)
You live on the fourth floor of a walk-up.

AMOND
(eyes closed)
No.

MARC
You'll have a fresh laparotomy, a drain and a mother. (beat) Four flights. Twice a day. With groceries.

AMOND
(eyes still closed)
No.

MARC
(pleasantly)
The front bedroom on the second floor's empty. There's a bathroom right next to it. Harmony makes grits. Raven makes gumbo when somebody almost dies. (beat) Four hundred dollars and groceries.

AMOND
(beat, opening one eye)
You're taking advantage of a man on morphine.

MARC
(beat)
Yes.

AMOND
(long beat, closing the eye)
We'll talk when I'm on less morphine.

MARC
(smiling)
That's a yes.

AMOND
(beat)
It's a "we'll talk."

MARC
(standing, tossing the banana peel in the bin)
In this house, that's a yes.

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 8:14 PM

Nadia sleeps. The contraction monitor is quiet: a flat line with small, rare bumps. Malik sits up when Marc comes in.

MALIK
(quietly)
Doc. You came back.

MARC
I said I would. (checking the strip) Two contractions in four hours. (beat) She's calming down. So is he.

MALIK
(beat)
Dr. Hartwell said you were operating on a friend.

MARC
(beat)
I was.

MALIK
(beat)
Is he okay?

MARC
(beat)
He's alive. He's mad. He's going to move into my house and pretend he isn't.

MALIK
(smiling)
That's a good friend.

MARC
(looking at Nadia, at the belly where a baby with a tumor scar is still growing)
Yeah. (beat) Twenty-six weeks and two days. (beat) Every day he stays in there, we win.

37 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 9:31 PM

Raven and Harmony at the island with leftover gumbo. Raven's been quiet all evening. Too quiet, for Raven.

RAVEN
(finally)
Harmony. (beat) Do you think Marc and Dr. Elxa Bullock are related?

Harmony's spoon stops halfway to her mouth.

HARMONY
(beat)
Bullock's a common name.

RAVEN
(putting down her spoon)
That's what everybody says. (beat) Everybody says it exactly the same way. Monty. Gloria. Arianna. Marc. (beat) It's like a password, Harmony. Like they all got the same memo.

HARMONY
(carefully)
Raven...

RAVEN
In OR Three today, Elxa said "my brother." (beat) She said "Lowery and my brother have him in Seven." (beat) And then she looked at me like I'd seen her naked.

Harmony looks down at her gumbo for a long moment.

HARMONY
(quietly)
If Marc has something he isn't telling us, Rave... (beat) He'll tell us when he's ready.

RAVEN
(beat)
You know something.

HARMONY
(beat)
I know he's the best man I've ever met. (beat) That's all I know. That's all I need to know.

The front door opens. Marc comes in, exhausted, and drops his bag. He sees the two of them looking at him.

MARC
What?

RAVEN
(beat, picking up her spoon)
Nothing. (beat) There's gumbo. (beat) Somebody almost died.

Marc sits down. Raven ladles him a bowl. She watches him eat it, very carefully, like a woman doing math.

38 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - BEDROOM - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 10:38 PM

The lights are off. Robert sits on the edge of the bed in his undershirt, his hands open on his knees, staring at them. Natasha comes in, in her robe, and sits behind him. She puts her arms around him.

ROBERT
(quietly)
I couldn't leave the table, Tasha.

NATASHA
(her cheek against his back)
I know.

ROBERT
I heard him hit the floor. I heard the Mayo stand go over. (beat) I could have put a clamp on the graft and turned around. Thirty seconds. (beat) I didn't. I finished the stitch.

NATASHA
(beat)
Because the man on your table would have died if you hadn't.

ROBERT
(beat)
That's the job. (beat) You can't leave the table. Not for your father, not for your son, not for... (he stops)

NATASHA
(softly)
Not for a boy you love like one.

A long silence.

ROBERT
(barely)
Our son held the artery. (beat) Lowery told me. Ninety seconds. (beat) I couldn't turn around, and he could.

NATASHA
(beat)
We raised a man who runs toward the bleeding, Robert. (beat) That's what scares me most about him. And it's the thing I'm proudest of.

She holds him. He finally lets his head drop.

NATASHA
(quiet, into his shoulder)
And Horace has been reading the attending CVs. (beat) Bernie saw the binder on his desk.

Robert goes very still in her arms.

39 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 10:52 PM

Esther at the galley table. The calendar. She draws the twenty-third red X. Seven left.

She takes Dr. Greenidge's card off the wall. Under "Ask myself the question. Not him," she writes a second line:

HANDWRITTEN, on the back of the card: "Don't let the calendar decide. -D.P.H."

She pins the card back up. She looks at it. Then at the calendar. Then she turns the calendar face down on the table.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

40 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 7 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2005 - 11:43 PM

The unit is dim. Amond is half asleep. The door slides open. HARRIET BAKER-FENWICK (52), tall, elegant, in a camel coat and pearls, a Louis Vuitton tote on one arm and a foil-covered casserole dish held in front of her like an offering, stands in the doorway. Behind her, DR. SOLOMON FENWICK (57), mild-mannered, gray-bearded, carrying two suitcases and a garment bag.

Harriet looks at her son: the NG tube, the blood bag, the drain.

HARRIET
(crisp)
Well. You look terrible.

AMOND
(opening his eyes)
Mom.

HARRIET
(crossing the room, setting the casserole on the tray table)
Macaroni and cheese. Four cheeses. For when they let you eat. (beat) Tomorrow is my fifty-third birthday, and I'm spending it in Queens. You're welcome. (beat) I made it at two o'clock in the morning. My time. (beat) I asked the flight attendant to keep it in the galley. She said no. I said "My son almost died." She said yes.

SOLOMON
(gently, from the doorway)
Hello, Amond.

AMOND
(beat)
Solomon.

Harriet sits on the edge of the bed. She takes in the gray of his skin, the bandage, the tube. Her composure begins, very slowly, to crack at the edges.

HARRIET
(sharp, then not sharp)
Stomachaches since you were seven. (beat) I told your father it was nerves. (beat) I told him you'd outgrow it.

AMOND
(beat)
It's not your fault, Mom.

HARRIET
(beat)
I know that. I'm a grown woman. (beat) I'm going to say it anyway, all night, and you're going to let me.

She takes his hand. Amond, who has spent seventeen years refusing to need anybody, holds on.

AMOND
(barely)
Mom.

Harriet puts her forehead down on their joined hands. Solomon sets down the suitcases and stands very quietly in the doorway, the way a man stands who has been waiting a long time to be let into a room.

MARC (V.O.)
Control is a lie surgeons tell themselves so we can pick up the knife.

41 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - MARC'S BEDROOM - DAWN
WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 5, 2005 - 5:15 AM

Gray light. Marc asleep, sprawled diagonally across the bed in his scrubs. On the nightstand, his phone buzzes. Once. He gropes for it, squints at the screen.

SMS, from AMOND: "you're late."

Marc stares at the screen. Then he starts to laugh, alone in the dark, with his hand over his eyes. The laughing turns into something else for a second. Then back into laughing.

MARC (V.O.)
The truth is, we don't control anything. (beat) We just show up. And hold on. And sometimes, if we're lucky, somebody holds on back.

He types back with one thumb.

SMS, to AMOND: "go back to sleep. the front bedroom's yours."

A long pause. Then:

SMS, from AMOND: "we'll talk."

Marc smiles at the ceiling.

MARC (V.O.)
In this house, that's a yes.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x03

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "MUSLIMS IN U.S. BEGIN RAMADAN FAST"

Tuesday, October 4, 2005

"Muslims across the United States began the monthlong Ramadan fast this week, abstaining from food and drink from dawn until sunset. Islamic law exempts the sick, travelers, pregnant women and others for whom fasting would be a hardship..."

NOBELPRIZE.ORG: The Nobel Prize in Physics 2005

Tuesday, October 4, 2005

"...awarded one half to Roy J. Glauber 'for his contribution to the quantum theory of optical coherence' and the other half jointly to John L. Hall and Theodor W. Hänsch 'for their contributions to the development of laser-based precision spectroscopy.'"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Tuesday, October 4, 2005, 2:40 PM

"Code in OR 2 this morning. Not a patient. An INTERN. Our spies say the cardiothoracic intern everyone is afraid of (you know the one: tailored scrubs, no small talk) went down mid-bypass. Six units. Lowery operated. Dr. X assisted and held something with two fingers that apparently kept him alive. The CT Chief kept sewing the whole time because he couldn't leave the table. Get well, Scary Intern. Nobody here is going to say it to your face, so we're saying it here." Comments (533).

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Marc-Anthony Bullock and Amond Baker)

Tuesday, October 4, 2005, 5:47 AM

Marc: "u alive?"

Amond: "Obviously."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Arianna Cummings to Marc-Anthony Bullock)

Tuesday, October 4, 2005, 7:55 AM

Arianna: "baker collapsed OR 2. GI bleed. big. go"

Dr. Kennerly's notebook (page 1)

Tuesday, October 4, 2005

"BULLOCK, M. -- from D.C. -- grandfather drove a bus (per Cummings) -- lives Hunters Pt w/ 3 roommates -- 'nice' -- Lowery let him assist (??) -- Chief smiles at him."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Amond Baker and Marc-Anthony Bullock)

Wednesday, October 5, 2005, 5:15 AM

Amond: "you're late."

Marc: "go back to sleep. the front bedroom's yours."

Amond: "we'll talk."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x03

New Canon Established

- **Amond's Meckel's diverticulum bled** on Tuesday, October 4, 2005, ten days before the scheduled October 14 surgery. He collapsed at 7:52 AM in OR 2 during Robert's CABG (an obtuse marginal graft), hit a Mayo stand, and his hemoglobin was 6.4, later 5.9. Robert could not leave the open chest. Lowery did an emergent laparotomy in OR 7 with **Marc assisting**, using 6 units of blood. Lowery resected 15 cm of ileum, including the 4 cm Meckel's and an ulcer that had eroded a mesenteric branch, about 55 cm from the ileocecal valve. **Marc held the bleeding mesenteric branch with two fingers for about 90 seconds** when a clamp slipped and the pressure fell to 60, then closed the common enterotomy. This is the R-4 counterpart of Cristina's ectopic rupture. Amond is expected to recover fully, per the No-Nerf rule.
- **Amond saw black stool at 11:52 PM on October 3** and didn't call Robert. He skipped his 5:15 AM 'you're late' text to Marc, the first time since August. Robert put him on **three weeks of medical leave** (from October 4, so back around October 25), still on Robert's service. Robert: 'Next time, press the button.' 'I know, son. But you are.'
- **Amond accepts the front second-floor bedroom** at the House on 49th Avenue ('we'll talk' means yes). He moves in during 2x04.
- **Harriet Baker-Fenwick** (her 53rd birthday is October 5) and **Dr. Solomon Fenwick** arrive from Los Angeles at 11:43 PM with four-cheese macaroni. 'Stomachaches since you were seven.' Odile Lemieux sat with Amond until Harriet came.
- **Raven heard Elxa say 'my brother'** in OR 3. Elxa denied it. Raven: 'It's like a password.' She asked Harmony; Harmony deflected ('he'll tell us when he's ready'). **Raven now strongly suspects Marc and Elxa are related.**
- **Whitlow connects Marc to Robert.** Arianna's cover story ('his grandfather drove a bus in D.C.'), passed on by Kennerly, matched Robert's CV ('son of Walter Bullock, WMATA Metrobus operator'). 'Not so common after all.' Kennerly is now Whitlow's informant on the medicine consult service. Whitlow also intends to raise 'supervision' (Robert and Amond) at the October 20 board meeting. Bernie saw the attending-CV binder on his desk.
- **Marc and Robert** in Stairwell C: 'That's the only plan anybody ever has. The rest is technique.' Natasha: 'We raised a man who runs toward the bleeding.'
- **Harmony** persuaded Brother Kareem Shabazz to accept surgery on the first day of Ramadan, citing Surah al-Baqarah 2:185 as Mrs. Gwendolyn Monroe taught it. **New canon:** Gwendolyn Monroe converted to Islam in 1985. Harmony tied a Graham patch with Dr. Boykin, and Lowery: 'That's two things I'll remember about today.'
- **Esther** (day 23) shaved Danielle Pryor-Hollis's head; Kevin shaved a stripe down his own. 'Don't let the calendar decide.' She agreed to dinner with Clayton on Thursday, October 6, after Dr. Greenidge, and turned her calendar face down.
- **Clayton** spotted Amond's anemia in the elevator ('the pale goes into the lips first') and doubled the blood-bank order. His line to Esther: 'You light up when you say his name.'

- **Kennerly** is back from suspension and on Whitlow's medicine consult service; his harassment hearing is 'next week.'

Knowledge Tracker (as of October 4, 2005)

Secret	Who knows	New pressure
Marc is Natasha and Robert's son	Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna, Esther	**Whitlow** has connected Marc to Robert; **Raven** suspects Marc is related to Elxa; Clayton suspects
Marc is Victor's grandson	Same, minus Monty	Whitlow is circling the August 9 loading-dock visit
Amond's illness	Now the whole hospital (the blog)	-
Harmony loves Marc	Raven, Esther	-

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Amond Baker	2/10/1979 (26)	Bleeding Meckel's diverticulum with ileal ulcer eroding a mesenteric branch; hemorrhagic shock (Hgb 5.9)	Ex-lap, segmental ileal resection (15 cm), stapled anastomosis (Lowery; Marc)	Stable; 6 units; leave 3 weeks
Kareem Shabazz	2/21/1953 (52)	Perforated anterior duodenal ulcer (presumed H. pylori)	Graham omental patch (Boykin; Harmony)	Stable; NPO; H. pylori testing
Tyrell Pickens	6/7/1989 (16)	Grade IV liver laceration, post-damage control	Second look: packs removed, fascia closed (Elxa; Raven)	Stable; clears tomorrow
Nadia Ellerbe	4/25/1977 (28)	Preterm contractions, POD 1 after open fetal surgery	Indomethacin and magnesium; fetal echo (Clayton; Marc)	Contractions settling; 26w2d; ductus open
CABG patient	-	Multivessel CAD	CABG (Robert; fellow)	Graft patent; home Friday

New Characters

- **Brother Kareem Shabazz** (b. February 21, 1953), a South Jamaica Sunni Muslim who has fasted every Ramadan since 1976, and **Sister Aminah Shabazz** (b. August 30, 1956).
- **Harriet Baker-Fenwick** and **Dr. Solomon Fenwick** make their on-screen debuts (already in MA-005). **Dr. Thaddeus Boykin** (PGY-3) debuts on screen. **Miss Pearline** (b. 1933), a 7 train rider.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Ramadan 1426 began in North America on or about October 4, 2005. The 2005 Nobel Prize in Physics (Glauber, Hall, Hänsch) was announced October 4. Surah al-Baqarah 2:184-185 exempts the sick from fasting.
- Medicine: a bleeding Meckel's diverticulum with ectopic gastric mucosa ulcerates the adjacent ileum, so segmental resection rather than a simple diverticulectomy is indicated. Hemorrhagic shock is managed with a rapid infuser and O-negative blood. A perforated duodenal ulcer is

repaired with a Graham omental patch, followed by H. pylori eradication. Indomethacin tocolysis after fetal surgery requires serial fetal echocardiograms to watch for ductal constriction. Pulse steroids cause cushingoid facial changes ('moon face').